

All the World's a Stage.

• Understanding the Text:

Answer the following questions:

a) Why does the poet compare the world with a stage?

Ans The poet compares the world with a stage because human life closely resembles a dramatic performance. Like actors, people come into the world, play their assigned roles and leave after their part is over. Every individual performs different roles at different times depending on age, duty and situation. These roles are temporary and constantly changing. Through this comparison, Shakespeare highlights the fleeting nature of life.

b) What is the first stage in a human's life?

Ans The first stage of human life is infancy. In this stage, a baby is completely helpless and dependent on parents or caretakers for survival. The infant cries frequently because it cannot express its needs through words. This makes the stage troubling not only for child but also for others. The baby has no control

over its actions or emotions, showing human weakness and vulnerability at the very beginning of life.

c) Describe the second stage of life based on the poem?

Ans. The second stage of life described in the poem is childhood, symbolized by the schoolboy. He carries a satchel and goes to school early in the morning. The poet shows that the boy moves slowly and unwillingly, comparing him to a snail. This stage reflects the beginning of responsibility, discipline and learning. It also shows how children often resist rules and obligations preferring freedom and comfort.

d) Why is the last stage called second childhood?

Ans. The last stage of life is called second childhood because old age makes a person weak, dependent and helpless much like an infant. In this stage, people lose physical strength, memory, teeth and eyesight. They are unable to care for themselves and rely on others for support. This stage completes the cycle of life, showing how humans return to a state of dependency before death, emphasizing life's circular nature.

e) In what sense are we the players in the world stage?

Ans Human beings are called players because they perform different roles throughout their lives, just like actors in a play. A ~~per~~ person becomes a child, student, lover, worker, parent and finally an old person. These roles are temporary and change with time. People cannot choose all their roles freely, as many are decided by age and circumstance. This idea shows that life follows a fixed pattern controlled by time and destiny.

- Reference to the content

a) Explain the following lines

All the world's a stage
And all the men and women merely players

Ans When Shakespeare says, "All the world's a stage", he means that life is like a play or drama. The world is the stage on which human beings perform their roles, just as a stage is a place where actors appear, act and leave. Life is a temporary place where people live out different roles.

The next line, "And all the men and

women merely players" explains that humans are like actors in this grand drama. Everyone has a part to play, with different roles and responsibilities at different stages of life. These roles change as we grow - from infancy to old age and none lasts forever.

Together these lines emphasize that life is transient, and we are all acting out the parts that time assigns to us, reminding us of the temporary and changing nature of human existence.

b) Explain the following lines briefly with reference to the content.

Ans

"They have their exits and their entrances, And one man in his time plays many parts."

Ans

These lines further develop Shakespeare's comparison of life to the theatrical performance. The poet explains that just as actors have entrances and exits on a stage, human beings also have "entrances" symbolize birth and "exit" symbolizes death. Between these two points, life unfolds like a drama.

Moreover, Shakespeare explains that one person plays many parts during their lifetime. These parts refers to the different roles a person assumes at different stages of life such as child, student, lover, worker, parent and old person. These roles are unavoidable and change naturally with time. Through these lines, Shakespeare emphasizes that human identity is not fixed. Life is a continuous process of change and people must adapt to new responsibilities and situations as they grow older.

c. Explain the 'Schoolboy' extract and answer the question.

(i) Which stage of life is being referred here by the poet?

Ans. The stage is "Schoolboy".

(ii) Which figure of speech has been employed in second line?

Ans. The figure of speech is simile.

(iii) Who is compared to snail?

Ans. Schoolboy is compared to snail.

④ Does the boy go to the school willingly?

Ans. No, the boy goes to the school unwillingly.

d) Simile and metaphor are major poetic devices. Explain.

Ans. Shakespeare uses metaphors and simile to make ideas vivid.

A simile is a figure of speech that compares two unlike things using words like "as" or "like". In the poem, the line "creeping like a snail" is a simile that compares schoolboy's slow ~~movement~~ movement to a snail.

A metaphor is a direct comparison without using "as" or "like". The line "All the world's a stage" a metaphor that compares human life to a drama and people to actors.

These devices help readers clearly visualize human behavior and understand the poet's philosophical view of life.

e) Which style does the poet use to express his emotions?

Ans. The poet uses philosophical and pessimistic style to express his thought. He presents life as a repetitive, temporary and ultimately meaningless. Through calm reflection rather than emotion, Shakespeare shows that human pride, love and power fade with time. The monologue form allows deep observation of human existence and emphasizes the inevitability of aging and death.

f) What is the theme of the poem?

Ans. The central theme of the poem is the transitory nature of human life. Shakespeare presents life as a continuous cycle in which human beings move through timed stage from birth to death.

Each stage has its own role, responsibilities and limitations, showing that nothing in life is permanent. Another important theme is the illusion of human importance. By comparing people to actors ~~as~~ on a stage, the poet suggests that human achievements, emotions & social positions are temporary performances. Power, Love and honor fade with time and no role lasts forever.

The poem also highlights the idea of inevitability and acceptance. Human cannot escape again ~~or~~ death and everyone must pass through some stages of life.

- Reference Beyond the Text

a) Describe the various stages of human life shown in the poem.

Ans The poem describes seven stages of human life - infancy, childhood, youth as the lover, adulthood as a soldier, maturity as a judge, old age and second childhood. This idea helps us understand how life changes from birth to death.

In infancy, a baby is completely helpless and depends on others. Childhood is shown through a schoolboy who goes to school unwillingly. The Lover is emotional and full of passion, while the soldier is brave, ambitious, and eager for honor.

The fifth stage is the justice, a mature and wise person respected by society. The sixth stage is old age, when strength decreases and life slows down. The final stage, second childishness, where a person loses memory

and becomes weak, similar to a child again.

b) Is Shakespeare's comparison of human's life with a drama stage apt? How?

Ans Yes, Shakespeare's comparison of human life with a drama stage is very apt. In real life, just like in a play, people play different roles at different times. No one remains the same throughout life. Our duties, behavior, and importance change as we grow older, just as an actor changes roles in a drama.

From childhood to old age, each stage of life has its own role and meaning. As children, we depend on others. As adults, we take responsibilities, work, love, and struggle. In old age, our strength and role in society slowly fade. All these stages appear and disappear one after another, like scenes in a play.

Moreover, just as a play ends, human life also comes to an end. No one can stay on the stage forever. Therefore, Shakespeare's comparison clearly and beautifully explains the temporary nature of human life and the changing roles people play, making it a very suitable and meaningful comparison.